Infoviz term: big data visualization

By the time you read this book, *big data* will probably sound as dated as *Pentium II*, *Rich Internet Application*, or *Buffy Cosplay*. Big data and all the excitement surrounding big data resulted from the broad availability of large datasets that were previously too large to handle. Often, big data is associated with exotic data stores like Hadoop or specialized techniques like GPU supercomputing (along with overpriced consultants).

But what constitutes *big* is in the eye of the beholder. In the domain of data visualization, the representation of big data doesn't typically mean placing thousands (or millions or trillions) of individual datapoints onscreen at once. Rather, it tends to mean demographic, topological, and other traditional statistical analysis of these massive datasets. Counterintuitively, big data visualization often takes the form of pie charts and bar charts. But when you look at traditional practice with presenting data interactively—natively—in the browser, the size of the datasets you're dealing with in this chapter really can be considered "*big*."

the zooming and panning of the map isn't so great. If you expect your users to be on mobile, then optimization is still a good idea.

Listing 11.5 Adding zoom controls to a map

```
var mapZoom = d3.behavior.zoom().translate(projection.translate())
    .scale(projection.scale()).on("zoom", zoomed);
d3.select("svg").call(mapZoom);

function zoomed() {
     projection
       .translate(mapZoom.translate())
       .scale(mapZoom.scale());

     d3.selectAll("path.sample").attr("d", geoPath);
     d3.selectAll("path.country").attr("d", geoPath);
};
```

We use projection zoom in this example because it'll be easier to draw canvas elements later.

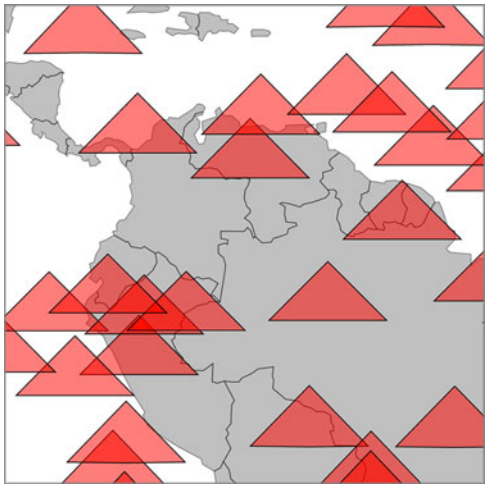


Figure 11.3 Zooming in on the sample geodata around South America